

GLP-1 Medication Guide

Audience analysis and deliverable outline

User research

Our team interviewed a total of nine audience members, all of them women between ages 38 and 80, with women age 55 and older providing the strongest representation. One team member also shared their personal experiences with GLP-1s.

Interview Guide

We broadly identified characteristics of our target persona:

1. Currently taking or thinking about taking GLP-1 agonist medications
2. Values accurate, unbiased information presented in plain language
3. May feel overwhelmed by conflicting information found online
4. Desires a concise, trustworthy guide that explains benefits, risks, and practical considerations of taking a GLP-1 medication

Below are the interview questions our team members asked participants who generally met the above characteristics:

1. What have you heard about GLP-1 medications? Where did you hear it from?
2. What do you know about the scientific research behind GLP-1s?
3. What concerns do you have about using GLP-1 medications for weight loss?
4. What do you know about the efficacy of GLP-1 medications for weight loss?
5. What information matters most to you when considering a new medication?
6. Where do you look for information when considering or learning about a new medication?
7. What barriers have you encountered when learning about GLP-1s or other medications?

Summary of findings

Our dominant audience is not anti-GLP-1, but cautious and skeptical. They are aware of the medications' popularity and effectiveness, yet their adoption is constrained by concerns about side effects, cost, long-term reliance, and lack of trusted medical guidance.

Physician endorsement and clear education are likely the strongest factors influencing acceptance.

Most individuals we interviewed are motivated to try GLP-1s by both emotional and functional factors:

- Desire to feel healthier and more confident
- Frustration with years of unsuccessful dieting
- Hope for a tool that could make weight management easier
- Improving energy and mobility
- Reach a healthier weight
- Reduce obesity-related health risks

Dominant barriers to starting GLP-1s are:

- Worried insurance won't cover the medication if the individual does not have diabetes
- Concerns about the out-of-pocket costs if insurance will not cover them
- Uncertainty about whether their primary care provider would write them a prescription for a GLP-1

Main concerns about taking a GLP-1 are:

- GI issues
- Medication interactions
- Bone density and muscle loss
- Unknown long-term consequences

Audience analysis

Below are the persona sheet, empathy map, and journey map for Linda. Linda is a composite character whose goals, concerns, age, and daily life closely match the average interviewee from the user research portion of our project. Linda is a 57-year-old GLP-1-curious woman who desires to lose 30-50 pounds. She is generally trusting of her healthcare provider and wants to make a sound, healthy decision about GLP-1 use in her health journey.

Persona map



LINDA
MARKETING MANAGER

- 57-year-old woman
- Struggles with weight and has tried every fad diet
- GLP-1 curious
- Enjoys and active lifestyle, including gardening at home and group fitness classes at the local YMCA

"I'm not looking for perfection, I'm looking for healthy progress."

A DAY IN THE LIFE

AM Linda wakes up thinking about her health more so than her appearance but also has concerns about the extra weight she carries. She scrolls through Facebook or watches morning news segments and occasionally sees stories or advertisements for Ozempic or Wegovy. She is curious, but skeptical of what she sees and wonders if there are things that the glossy testimonials aren't telling her about.

Linda works from home and is busy and active during the day, but experiences fatigue, some joint pain, and loss of stamina compared to how she felt 10-15 years earlier. As she goes about her day, she wonders if maybe losing 30-50 pounds might help her energy levels and achy knees.

AFTERNOON She calls her doctor's office to schedule her annual physical and wonders if she should bring up GLP-1s in her appointment. Though Linda trusts her physician, she worries about initiating the conversation about weight loss medications as she is not diabetic and is relatively healthy and active despite the extra weight she carries.

Linda tries to make healthier food choices throughout the day and is intentional about her afternoon walks and staying active by going to occasional group fitness classes at her local YMCA. She is frustrated that her positive lifestyle choices don't translate into weight loss.

EVENING Linda reads more about GLP-1s online, looking specifically for stories from women like herself. She searches for more information about the side effects, long-term safety concerns, and if women re-gained weight after stopping the medication. She decides that she will ask her doctor about GLP-1 medication and her concerns in her upcoming annual physical.

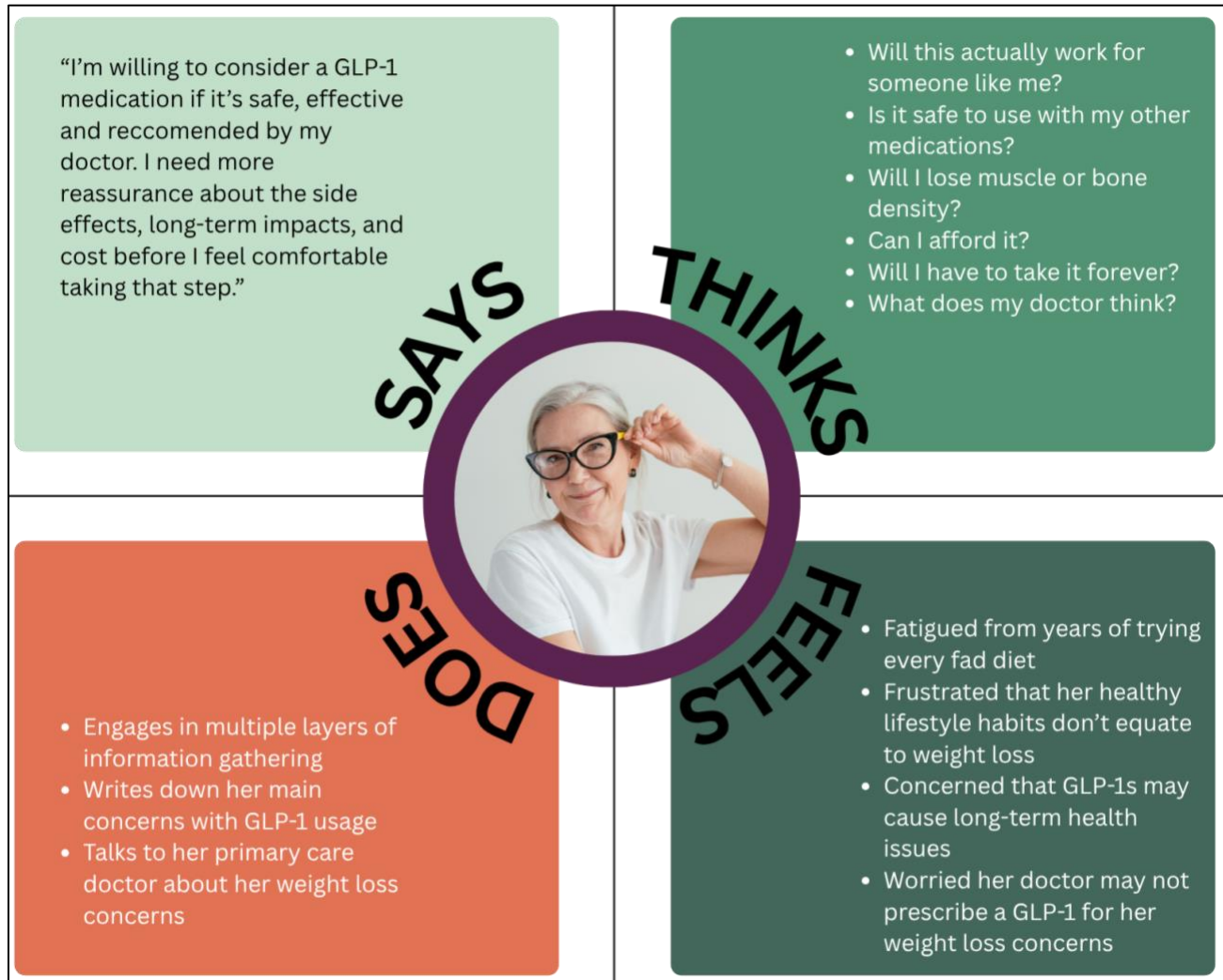
GOALS

- Achieve sustainable weight loss
- Make an informed medical decision
- Improve health without sacrificing quality of life

CONCERNS

- Insurance coverage or out-of-pocket expenses
- Side effects
- Long-term safety and effectiveness of GLP-1 medications

Empathy map



Journey map

 LINDA MARKETING MANAGER "I'm not looking for perfection, I'm looking for healthy progress."		SCENARIO Linda has struggled to lose weight despite healthy habits. She wants trustworthy information before deciding whether to discuss GLP-1 medications with her physician.		GOALS • Make an informed medical decision • Understand benefits and risks • Feel confident discussing treatment options with her doctor • Avoid misinformation • Determine whether GLP-1 therapy is appropriate for her
STAGE	 Awareness	 Research	 Decision	
Needs	Hope	Trusted Information	Confidence	
Activities	Struggles to lose weight despite diet and exercise. Begins hearing about GLP-1 medications through news, social media, friends, or advertisements.	Searches online for information. Encounters conflicting opinions and misinformation. Reads the educational brochure.	Contacts insurance or researches coverage. Schedules an appointment with her physician. Discusses whether GLP-1 medication is appropriate for her.	
Thoughts	"Could this finally work for someone like me?"	Creates a list of questions and concerns. I need information I can actually trust	"Now I feel prepared to ask the right questions."	
Emotions	Curious and Skeptical	Overwhelmed, then increasingly reassured	Confident	
Content Opportunities	Present evidence-based information in plain language. Address common misconceptions. Explain benefits and risks objectively. Include practical questions patients can ask their physician. Explain insurance and cost considerations. Direct readers toward conversations with healthcare professionals instead of self-diagnosis.			

Outline of deliverable

Front cover

You eat right and exercise but can't lose weight. Could GLP-1 agonist medications be right for you? *Graphic* with 3 prongs of weight-loss therapy: lifestyle intervention (diet, exercise), bariatric surgery (gastric sleeve, gastric bypass), and pharmacotherapy.

Inside page 1

What are GLP-1 agonists? (We'll need to figure out how to refer to this group of drugs, as they are interchangeably called GLP-1s, GLP-1 RAs, and incretin agonists. One drug on the market also is a dual GLP-1/GIP agonist, not sure if we need to define this).

How do they work? Mention effectiveness here.

Who are they for? Mention original use for diabetes, FDA approval (but one is not FDA approved for weight loss, even though it is used for it, how to mention this if at all). Double check that pivotal studies were done alongside lifestyle intervention *pretty sure they were.

Inside page 2

Known side effects, rare side effects. Could do *graphic* like a pie chart? Need to get some numbers from original studies.

How to mitigate side effects (stress close monitoring by MD)

Risk of weight regain (again more close monitoring by MD, there are ways to minimize this). Could do a *graphic* on the risk of weight re-gain, as it's obvious and impressive in the literature.

Inside page 3

Unknowns (science has not definitively answered these questions) – muscle, bone health.

Back cover

Checklist to prepare for MD appointment (include calling insurance company here, tips on the Novo Nordisk and Eli Lilly programs available)